



# The Exhibit Promo Tool

A concept project to promote our open calls and exhibitions — and attract more submissions. This deck explains the project, what we already own, and the **decisions to make before we build.**

Concept · Pre-build

Graduated from Idea 011

Not Real Art · Artsville · Arterial

WHAT THIS PROJECT IS

# A Concept, Graduated From the Ideas Inbox

The ideas-inbox captures, researches, and evaluates ideas before they become projects. Idea 011 — Owned Promotion & PR Engine reached "Recommend Pilot" — so it graduates here into its own concept repo to be designed properly.

## ✓ Done in this repo

Background & education · the systems map · the 66-channel directory · a PressRanger product deep-dive · the build-vs-integrate analysis · a decision register

## ⌚ Still to come

Use cases · user-centric tasks · the press-release / PressRanger integration design · the per-call promotion checklist — *all blocked on the key decisions*

## ⌚ Not yet

No code. No build. We are deliberately deciding **what** to build and **where** before writing any.

WHY WE'RE DOING THIS

# We Run Open Calls — We Don't Promote Them

We're excellent at *running* open calls and exhibitions, and almost nothing promotes them beyond our own small email list. **Submission volume is the lever** — it compounds into better shows, a bigger community, press leverage, and nonprofit public support.

## No repository

Press & outreach contacts live in inboxes and people's heads.

## No active owner

Promotion is whoever-has-time — so it mostly doesn't happen.

## No PR cadence

Releases go out sporadically — not before, on, and after each call.

The evidence it works: the grant campaigns over-performed because we ran **Facebook ads to the landing pages**. Open calls deserve the same treatment — measured, this time. → [research/01-why-promote-open-calls.md](#)

THE FRAMING THAT DECIDES EVERYTHING

# It's Three Layers, Not One App

Most of the "which app do we build this on?" debate dissolves once you see this isn't one application — it's three layers, each with a different natural home.

## Engine

Content gen → approval →  
schedule → publish → paid ads.

Already exists: PolyWiz

## Data + CRM

Contacts, pitches, coverage, registry,  
open-call & submission data.

Partly exists: Airtable

## Packaging

Who it's for, how it's sold: internal ·  
multi-brand · white-label.

A choice — not yet made

"Which app" becomes "which layer goes where" — and only packaging is genuinely open.

WHAT WE ALREADY OWN

# The Stack Is the Spine — We Rent Only Inputs

## PressRanger

owned feed — swappable  
Journalist DB + pitch radar



## PolyWiz

the engine — our spine  
Gen · approval · schedule · publish (14  
platforms) · ads



## Artwork Archive

Airtable system-of-record  
Open-call records + submissions =  
conversion signal

"Open Call" is already a scaffolded PolyWiz campaign type  
— disabled, ~1 hour to enable organic. Press release = a new  
output format. Paid ads = polywiz-app#181.

Same principle as Idea 009: own the engine; rent only  
swappable inputs. → [research/03-related-systems.md](#)

THE DEMAND LAYER

# 66 Verified Channels, Mostly Free & Unused

Before building anything, we mapped where to promote calls and find funding — every row drives artists back to *our own* submission page. 43 of 66 are free.

24

Fundraising / grants / donor

18

Open-call listings

15

Media / PR amplifiers

6

Partner orgs / councils

3

Paid-ads channels

Each row carries an action URL, cost, self-service level, effort — and a ready-made **UTM slug** so every promoted link is attributable. → [research/04-channel-directory.md](#) · [arts-master-resource.csv](#)



THE REALITY CHECK ON PRESSRANGER

# It Can't Be a Live Feed — CSV Export Only

PressRanger's media database + CRM + AI would cost \$3K-\$40K/yr elsewhere, and we own it on a lifetime deal. But for *integrating* it, the deep-dive surfaced a hard constraint:

## No API • No Zapier • No webhooks

The only integration is a Claude MCP server — and it exposes **only your own companies + draft releases**, never the contact database.

## Egress = manual CSV, tier-capped

~4,000 records/mo on our Tier 3. So integration is a **periodic batch ETL** — export → Airtable import — not a live sync.

Plus noisy keyword-matched beats and patchy emails (one test: **8 of 100** contacts had an email). Use it for **discovery**; own the CRM ourselves. → [research/05-pressranger-deep-dive.md](#)

BUILD VS. INTEGRATE

# No Clone to Fork — Build Thin on Our Stack

A full GitHub sweep found **no forkable PressRanger** — only SEO-spam repos and zero-star hackathon agents. PressRanger's moat is its *journalist database*, which is proprietary and *not our use case*: we manage our **own** contacts.

## Recommendation

Build a **thin CRM on Next.js + Airtable + Claude + n8n**:  
Contacts · Pitches · Coverage · Registry. Keep PressRanger as a swappable discovery feed.

## Don't over-build

Adopting a heavyweight CRM (Twenty, EspoCRM) adds a second datastore, auth, and self-host burden to replace what Airtable already does. **Simplicity first.**

Revisit Twenty only if we outgrow Airtable. → [research/06-build-vs-integrate-and-oss-landscape.md](#)



# Potential MVP — The Open-Call Playbook & Tracker

The reference table we built won't get used on its own — people glance at it, then post by hand with no record. Evolve it from a *lookup* into a **worklist that does the busy-work and logs it**: tell it the exhibition → it preps the content per place → you post & tick off → we can see what got done.

## ★ Favorites

Star ~10 boards we actually use; persisted in **Airtable** as a permanent filter. Choose once; it sticks.

## Scrape & prep

Paste the open-call URL → pull the details → AI preps **ready-to-paste content per board**. Reuses PolyWiz's scrape + AI.

## Checklist + log

Tick off each post; timestamp, who, response — an **auditable record** per call. Fixes the "messy, untracked" problem.

**Honest scope**: assisted + *tracked manual* submission — it preps, opens the site, and records it. It does **not** auto-fill the boards (no APIs; brittle by nature). → [concept/promotion-playbook-and-tracker.md](#)

# Keep PolyWiz Generic — Build the Checklist Standalone

PolyWiz was never meant to be art-specific — it's a **general-purpose social tool** (The Intersect + other clients) with multiple campaign types. Baking in a directory of arts listing boards is **feature creep**. So "promote the open call" splits in two:

## GENERIC → POLYWIZ

### Social amplification

Posts & ads about the call. "Make content for a thing with a deadline" is domain-agnostic — fine as a campaign type. Stays usable for any client.

## ARTS-SPECIFIC → STANDALONE

### Submission checklist / tracker

Arts listing boards, per-board submission recipes, the posting log. A **self-standing utility** — what the Perplexity app already is today.

The standalone tool *calls* PolyWiz for the generic parts and owns only the arts layer — keeping PolyWiz generic, and making a future white-label arts product a clean standalone.

THE DECISIONS BEFORE WE BUILD

# Seven Questions — One of Them Is the Root

Before use cases or schemas, the team (Scott · Elise · Juergen) has to answer a set of architectural & strategic questions. Most of them lean the same way — **except one, which everything else hangs on.**

## **The root question — Decision 5**

Are we building a **tool** (internal, promote our own calls) — or a **product** (white-label PR-as-a-service for other arts orgs)?

Almost every other decision reads "lean X if internal, lean Y if product." Answer this first and the rest resolve.

Full reasoning, options, and tradeoffs → [concept/00-key-decisions.md](#)

# It Splits in Two (per the consideration above)

## LEAN ✓ · GENERIC

### Social amplification → PolyWiz

Posts & ads for the call as a generic campaign type. PolyWiz already *is* this engine; stays usable for The Intersect & other clients.

## LEAN ✓ · ARTS-SPECIFIC

### Checklist / tracker → standalone

The evolved Perplexity utility over Airtable. Keeps PolyWiz generic; *calls* it for the generic content parts.

### Not Artwork Archive

It's the *data* home (open-call + submission records), with **no** engine. Don't rebuild PolyWiz inside it.

**Data layer** → a cleanly-namespaced Airtable (the Artwork Archive base). The split keeps one generic engine, one arts-specific tool, one shared data hub. → [concept/00-key-decisions.md](#)

# Internal Tool, or White-Label SaaS?

Scott's instinct: *"turn it into some kind of service for artists or galleries."* And PressRanger is already white-label/reseller-ready — so a service could be largely **resell + our playbook + our brand.**

## A • Internal only

Smallest build, fastest value. Leaves the revenue instinct on the table.

LEAN ✓

## B • Internal now, product-ready

Prove the playbook on ourselves first; keep data portable + brands agnostic. Low-regret. Most of the "keep-open" work our rules already mandate.

## C • White-label day one

Pays the multi-tenant + billing + support cost **before** the playbook is proven. High risk.

Review alongside Idea 004 (Multi-Tenant) + Idea 009 (Owned Platform) — white-label PR may belong with those.

## DECISIONS AT A GLANCE

# Seven Leans — All Gated by the Root

| # | DECISION                     | LEAN                                                   | GATED BY |
|---|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 1 | Engine / tool host           | Splits: social → PolyWiz · arts checklist → standalone | #5       |
| 2 | Data / CRM host              | Airtable — Artwork Archive base, namespaced            | #5       |
| 3 | One product or two           | Two layered capabilities                               | #5       |
| 4 | Multi-brand vs. multi-tenant | Multi-brand now, tenant-ready                          | #5       |
| 5 | Internal vs. white-label     | Internal now, product-ready — THE ROOT                 | —        |
| 6 | User surface (Elise)         | Reuse PolyWiz + Airtable; no new app yet               | #5       |
| 7 | PressRanger role             | Swappable discovery feed                               | settled  |

Answer #5 — even as "tool for now, revisit after Phase 1" — and 1–4 + 6 resolve to these leans.



## THE RECOMMENDATION

# The Low-Regret Path

- 1 Build the engine capability in PolyWiz — enable "Open Call," add press-release output, wire the #181 ads pilot. Reversible — it's our engine either way.
- 2 Build the thin CRM/registry in a clean Airtable — Contacts · Pitches · Coverage · Registry. Brand-agnostic, portable — lifts into a tenant base later if needed.
- 3 Run Phase 1 on one real call (*Art of Resistance*) with a ~\$250 paid flight — and measure cost-per-submission for the first time.
- 4 Defer the white-label decision until that data exists — then decide tool-vs-product with evidence.

Every step delivers internal value *and* is a prerequisite for the product version. Deferring costs nothing.

READ THE FULL THINKING

# Where Everything Lives

## RESEARCH (THE WHY & WHAT EXISTS)

- 01 · why promote open calls
- 02 · background & context
- 03 · related systems
- 04 · channel directory (+ CSV)
- 05 · PressRanger deep-dive
- 06 · build-vs-integrate landscape

## CONCEPT (THE DECISIONS & DESIGN)

- 00 · key decisions ← start here
  - use cases (to come)
  - user-centric tasks (to come)
  - PressRanger integration (to come)
  - promotion checklist (to come)

## UPSTREAM LINEAGE

- Idea 011 — this concept's parent
- Idea 007 — paid-ads engine
- Idea 009 — own-the-layer
- Idea 004 — multi-tenant
- polywiz-app#181 — ads epic

# Sources & References

Clickable — evidence behind this deck

[This project \(repo docs\)](#) — [github.com/JuergenB/polywiz-exhibit-promo-tool](https://github.com/JuergenB/polywiz-exhibit-promo-tool) · the [research/](#) folder (01–06) and [concept/00-key-decisions.md](#) carry full per-claim sources + confidence flags.

[Parent idea & lineage](#) — Idea 011 (Owned Promotion & PR Engine) · 007 paid-ads · 009 owned platform · 004 multi-tenant · [polywiz-app#181](#) ads epic.

[PressRanger](#) — [features](#), [no-API finding](#), [data quality](#) — [pressranger.com/pages/pr-software](https://pressranger.com/pages/pr-software) · docs (Claude-MCP-only integration) · AppSumo reviews (8-of-100 emails; keyword beats). Full teardown: [research/05](#).

[Wire & software pricing](#) — EIN Presswire ~\$149 · eReleases CauseWire (nonprofit) · PR Newswire \$1,500–3,000 · Cision / Meltwater / Prowly estimates.

[OSS build-vs-integrate](#) — Twenty CRM · coldoutboundskills · mailmerge. Full landscape + verdicts: [research/06](#).

[Master channel directory \(66 verified\)](#) — live build: [arterial-art-exhibition-promotion-resources.pplx.app](https://arterial-art-exhibition-promotion-resources.pplx.app) · data: [research/arts-master-resource.csv](#).

Pricing & capability claims current June 2026 — verify before quoting. AppSumo tier figures flagged low-confidence; re-verify on the live listing. Full URLs, retrieval dates, and high/medium/low confidence flags live in the verification sections of [research/05](#) and [research/06](#).



# One Question Unblocks the Rest

We already own the engine, the data hub, and the feed. The research is done; the decisions are framed. The single thing standing between "questions" and "design" is one answer: **are we building a tool, or a product?**

Answer that, and I can start the use-cases, schema, and integration design. — Juergen Berkessel, Polymash